

Japan Technology: Hardware - Electronic Components: May MOF trade data (MLCC): MoM affected by long holiday but value up +19% YoY; Buy

According to the Ministry of Finance (MOF) trade statistics for May, announced on June 26, the average export price for MLCCs was down -3% mom, while export volume was down -10%, and export value was down -12%. On a yoy basis, these figures were +11%/+7%/+19%. We surmise that the mom decline reflects the impact of the long holiday period on shipments. Meanwhile, yoy growth remains high.

In our conference call with Murata Mfg. this week ([LINK](#)), we confirmed that despite the seasonality in May due to the Golden Week holiday, order trends are at a very high level. The company commented that very strong orders for AI/DC applications are continuing, and that the sense of recovery in automotive applications has been strengthening recently. We interpret the latest trade data as being in line with this tone.

For the 1Q results, rather than the 1Q earnings themselves (which are affected by the timing of sales recognition), we will be focusing on the Apr-Jun book-to-bill ratio, the outlook for Jul-Sep, and the company's tone heading into 2H, where we expect a significant improvement in the product mix (higher ASP) from AI server MLCCs. In addition, regarding discussions of price hikes on a like-for-like basis, we see the period around year-end, when 2027 comes into view, as a more important checkpoint than the 1Q results season. We maintain our Buy ratings on Murata Mfg. (on CL), Taiyo Yuden, and TDK.

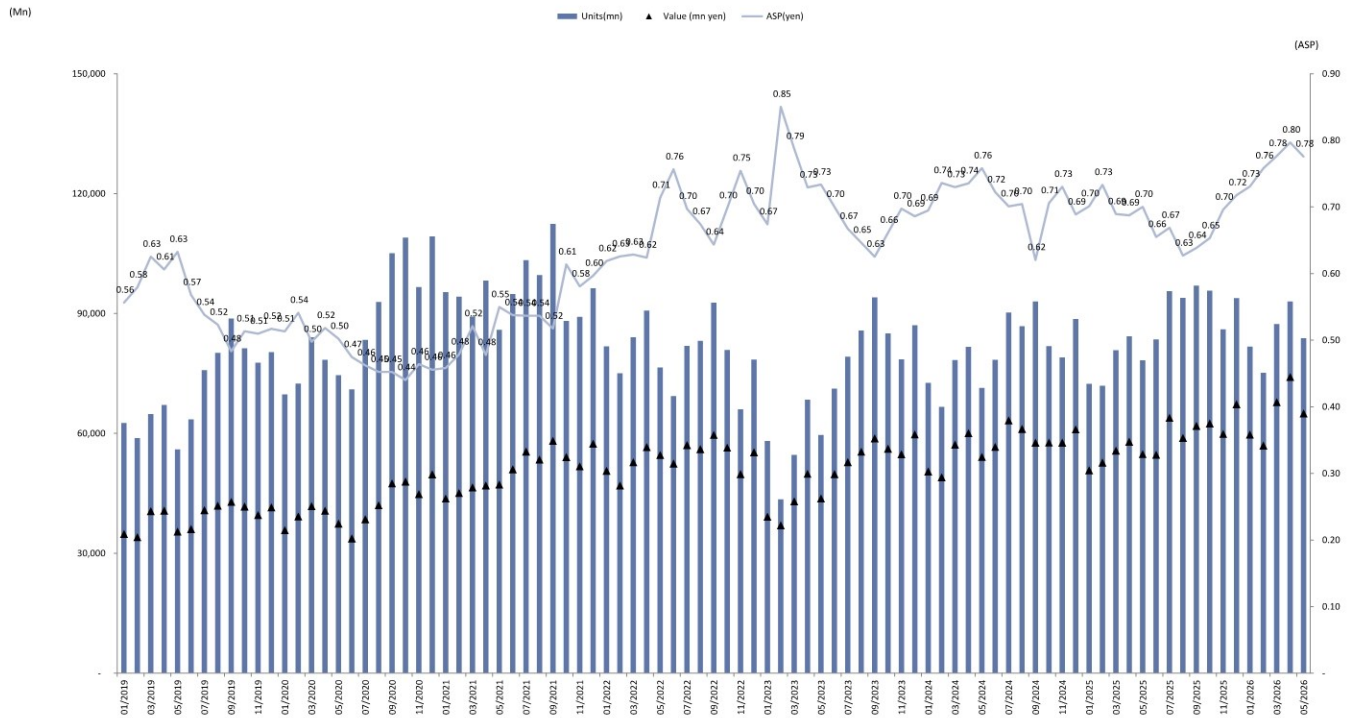
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Exhibit 1: MLCC export volume and average export price(ASP)

Source: Ministry of Finance

Price Target Risks and Methodologies**Price Target Risks and Methodology – Murata Mfg.**

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Murata Mfg. with a 12-month price target of ¥12,600. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (implies FY3/29E P/E of 30X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Taiyo Yuden

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Taiyo Yuden with a 12-month price target of ¥21,200. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (our TP implies FY3/28E P/E of 31X).

Key risks: Weaker-than-expected smartphone demand, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – TDK

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on TDK with a 12-month price target of

¥4,600. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 10% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (implies FY3/28E P/E of 31X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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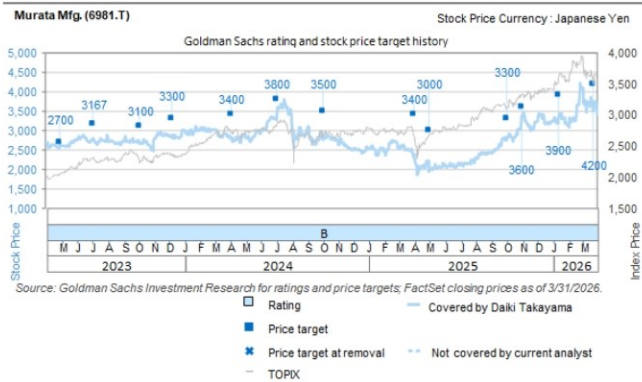
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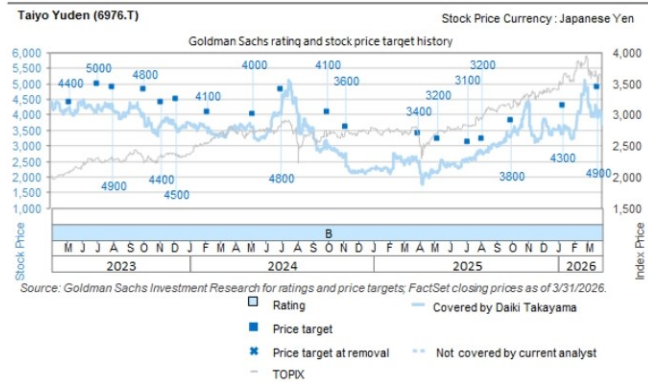
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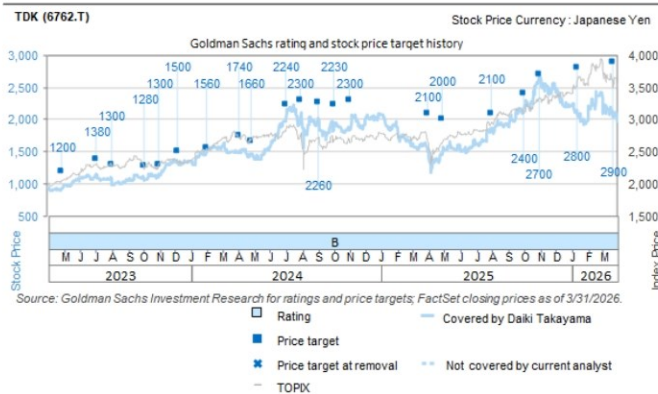
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Target price history table(s)

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	21,200	14,975
08-May-26	7,100	6,663
23-Mar-26	4,900	3,926
12-Jan-26	4,300	3,405
02-Oct-25	3,800	3,382
05-Aug-25	3,200	2,841
07-Jul-25	3,100	2,488
09-May-25	3,200	2,202
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,467
07-Nov-24	3,600	2,781
01-Oct-24	4,100	3,081
02-Jul-24	4,800	4,105
08-May-24	4,000	3,643

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	12,600	8,711
30-Apr-26	5,400	5,156
23-Mar-26	4,200	3,508
12-Jan-26	3,900	3,194
31-Oct-25	3,600	3,392
02-Oct-25	3,300	2,770
30-Apr-25	3,000	2,214
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,306
01-Oct-24	3,500	2,893
02-Jul-24	3,800	3,364
03-Apr-24	3,400	2,768
06-Dec-23	3,300	2,892
04-Oct-23	3,100	2,657

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
07-Feb-24	4,100	3,431
06-Dec-23	4,500	3,627
07-Nov-23	4,400	3,695
04-Oct-23	4,800	3,963
03-Aug-23	4,900	4,164
04-Jul-23	5,000	4,330

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
04-Jul-23	9,500	2,778

TDK (6762.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	4,600	3,715
28-Apr-26	3,000	2,677
23-Mar-26	2,900	2,043
12-Jan-26	2,800	2,142
31-Oct-25	2,700	2,673
02-Oct-25	2,400	2,154
01-Aug-25	2,100	1,876
28-Apr-25	2,000	1,460
31-Mar-25	2,100	1,546
01-Nov-24	2,300	1,848
01-Oct-24	2,230	1,948
02-Sep-24	11,300	2,023
30-Jul-24	11,500	2,029
02-Jul-24	11,200	2,004
26-Apr-24	8,300	1,462
03-Apr-24	8,700	1,488
31-Jan-24	7,800	1,488
06-Dec-23	7,500	1,338
01-Nov-23	6,500	1,158
04-Oct-23	6,400	1,052
02-Aug-23	6,500	1,089
04-Jul-23	6,900	1,150

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